Suddaby School Council

September 18, 2023

Present: Barb Tompkins, Sarah Taylor, Katherine Akins, Katha Broschek, Joel Leslie, Karin Korth, Lisa Farlow, Sue Campbell, Jill Kraft, Neil Callaghan, Annie Doran,. Tiina Rendas, Mel McShane, Simon McNaughton, Amanda Hunter, Tiffany moore

Introduction:

What is a School Council?

- An advisory role committee only; the ultimate responsibility for the administration and day-to-day school operations rests with the Principal
- A means to advise the Principal on any matter pertaining to pupil achievement
- A voice to provide input to the school Board, when asked for input on policies, plans etc.

Review of Council Roles:

- Chair - Leads the meetings, co-creates the agenda, and communicates with the school community.
- Secretary - Ensures that they thoroughly and accurately record the meetings
- Treasurer - Ensures that the funds raised by the Council are tracked separately and records are maintained.
- WRAPSC Rep - Attends 6 WRAPSC meetings, reports back on any items of interest

Opportunities:

- School Council Chair
- Secretary
- Treasurer
- WRAPSC Rep
- Sub committees - fundraising, schoolyard revitalization/kindy playground, equity, communications
- Volunteers are elected or (if only one volunteer) acclaimed

All elected roles from 2022/23 resigned, new roles to be filled as follows (all acclaimed):

Chair: Lisa Farlow

Secretary: Karin Korth

Treasurer: Mel McShane

WRAPSC Rep: Amanda Hunter

Communications (non-elected): Simon McNaughton

Administrators' Report:

- **Enrollment update:** Suddaby currently has 503 students in 22 classes (with possible increase to 23 classes)
- **Spirit Day:** Students were encouraged to wear something that represented anything that was important to them as a person. We talked about their culture, foods they like, celebrations, sports teams, family values, etc. It was wonderful to see how happy students were as they shared what was important to them. Here are some great pictures of our Suddaby students on our first Spirit Day to celebrate individual differences.

Financial Report:

School funds: 20,000 $
Wefi: 8,500$

Total: 28,500$

Reserve fund:: 10 000 $

Note: previously, $5,000 (of this $28,500 total) had been allotted to the Equity Committee of this Council to support Equity-based initiatives. $3,500 of this allotment remains unspent. A motion to disband the Equity Committee (at least in its current form), and return the $3,500 to the Council's general funds was proposed. ***MOTION PASSED***

Teachers' Report:

- Request for outdoor equipment for individual classrooms: basketballs, soccer balls, volley balls, gaga balls, soft frisbees, and a tote to store them in.
- Request to look into disc golf equipment for the back of the yard.

WRAPSC Report:

- It was suggested that Council vote on when to have meetings

Playground Report:

- The playground revitalization committee (also known as Lisa) requests input from one or more kindergarten teachers regarding which structures they would actually like to see in the new playground
- The fences around the Kindie playground need to be changed to be less climbable. What the WRDSB will pay for toward this end will be made/followed up on

Strong Start:

- Strongstart is an early literacy support program run by volunteers in the school. Volunteers will be paired with children for 10 30-minute (typically weekly) sessions. Training is provided (and mandatory), both online and in person, free of charge.
- Volunteers are badly needed; if you would like to help please contact Katherine Akins at kakins@rogers.com
- Strong Start Link for training: https://strongstart.ca/programs/letters-sounds-and-words/training/

- The WRDSB now requires all volunteers to complete the volunteer interview form and reference check below, and to provide a Vulnerable Sector Check by the WRPS. There is a fee for the WRPS check of $20 if you indicate that it is required for a volunteer position. If you wish to volunteer and require assistance covering the WRPS fee, please contact Suddaby administration.
- Volunteer Interview Form https://staff.wrdsb.ca/policyprocedure/files/2020/02/Appendix-A-Volunteer-Application.pdf
- Volunteer Reference Check form https://staff.wrdsb.ca/policyprocedure/files/2020/02/Appendix-B-Reference-Check.pdf
- WRPS Vulnerable Sector Check: https://www.wrps.on.ca/en/services-reporting/police-vulnerable-sector-check.aspx

Other Business:

- **Improving accessibility of Council meetings:** We will be looking into facilitating meeting attendance through Google meets for parents who wish to join but are unable to meet in person. Purchasing microphones was proposed, other suggestions are welcome.
- In June 2023, Council voted to spend up to $1000 to supplement Nutrition 4 Learning, covering the lag between the start of the school year and the start of N4L. $950 was spent.

Future Business:

- Next meeting: October 16, 2023

- Discussion points to include fundraising going forward (ask for each member of council to come with any new fundraising ideas)